

AUTONOMY

Chaos does not come from too much freedom.

How to let go of the team without it turning into
chaos.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

It comes from people who do not know how far they can
go without asking.

THE CASCADE

The autonomy cycle that lasts two weeks.



WHAT YOU SEE

You announce autonomy in a meeting, and nothing else changes...



THE MECHANISM

...everyone starts deciding with a different yardstick...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...the first mistake lands, and you pull it all back.

Autonomy announced and not designed comes back as double the control.

THE FORK

Autonomy, abandonment or theater.

THE YARDSTICK

01

Knows the outcome and the decision ceiling? Autonomy.

02

Finds the limit by getting it wrong? Abandonment.

03

You say you trust and approve everything? Theater.

Autonomy can be split, accountability for the result cannot.

THE METHOD

The Autonomy Contract, four clauses.

01 **OUTCOME**

what has to happen, never the step by step of how

02 **LIMIT**

how far each one decides alone, in money, time and risk

03 **ONE RULE**

three non negotiable rules at most, all in writing

04 **SIGNAL**

what forces a call to you first, with no fear of calling

It fits in four lines. If it does not fit, it is not clear yet.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Decision ceilings written the way you talk.

01 • OUTCOME

Spend.

up to five thousand is yours, above that you call me first

02 • LIMIT

Client.

a discount up to ten percent is yours, above that it is mine

03 • ONE RULE

Technical.

reversible change goes ahead, irreversible stops at my desk

04 • SIGNAL

Deadline.

one day late you tell me, one week late we replan together

TWO MODELS

A forty page manual or a one page contract.

THE COMMON MODEL

The thick manual

A rule for every exception

Approval in a chain

Nobody remembers what it says

Decisions stall and wait for you

THE DESIGNED MODEL

The short contract

Three non negotiable rules

A ceiling by money and risk

Everyone can recite it

Decisions move and come back reviewed

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that teach the team to wait.

01 Punishing the first mistake of someone who decided alone.

- the message is clear, deciding around here is dangerous.

02 Moving the yardstick after the call was made.

- whoever gets corrected by a new rule never risks again.

03 Staying the only one who approves.

- your inbox contradicts every speech about trust.

The team does not listen to what you announce, it watches what you approve.

THE CHAIN

The same sentence test.

01

You write in one line how far the person decides alone.



02

The person writes the same line, without seeing yours.



03

Different sentences? That is not autonomy, that is guesswork.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Five minutes per person, and you find where the chaos is born.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Half an hour to write the first contract.



STEP 01

List the last ten decisions that came through you.

mark the ones that never needed to reach you



STEP 02

Write the ceiling in one line with whoever asks you most.

money, time and risk, in everyday language



STEP 03

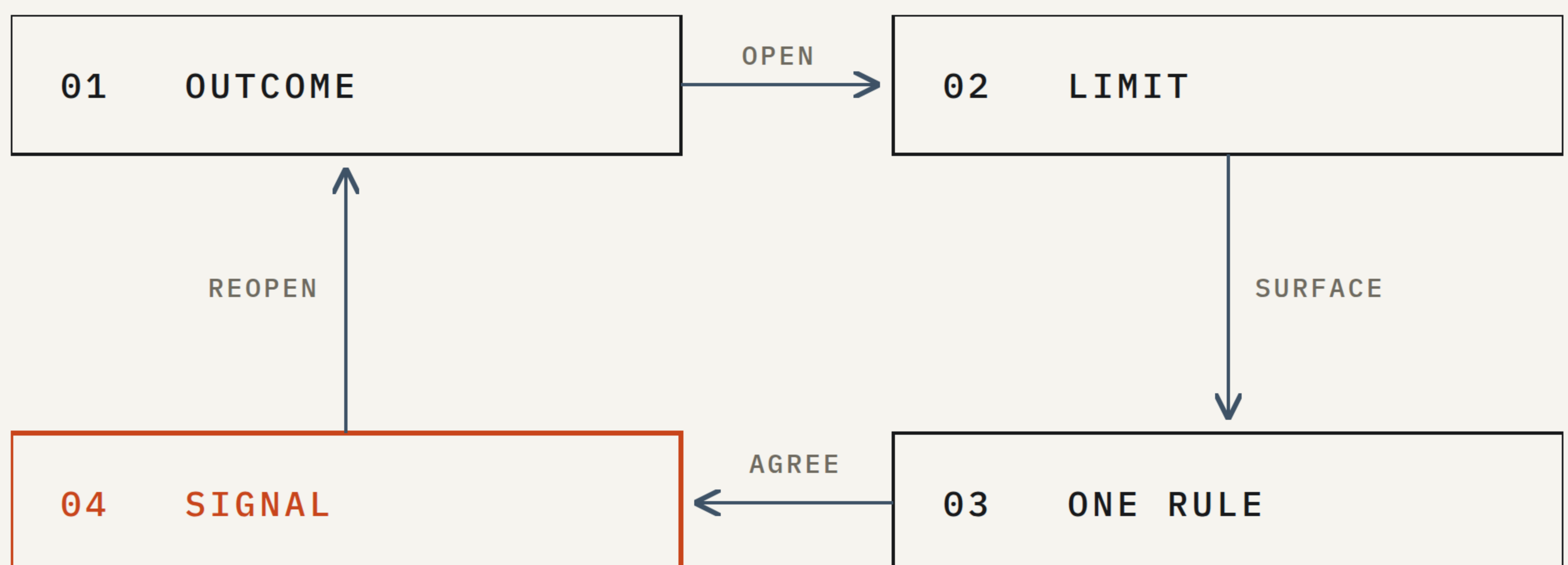
Agree the signal, what forces a call to you first.

with a clear signal, the rest can move without you

Autonomy starts existing the day it is written down.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Autonomy Contract, a loop and not a list.



**Autonomy is not born of an announcement.
It is born of a written agreement.**

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

next time the team stops to ask you.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA